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IMPORTANT BATTLES IN INDIAN HISTORY

Ancient India • Medieval India • Colonial India • World Wars • Post-Independence

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Fact-checked and redesigned as an original Jumpstart Academy study resource. Dates, outcomes and major factual errors in the supplied reference have been corrected where necessary.

1. Ancient Indian Wars

Selected important conflicts from the ancient period. Where exact dates are debated or uncertain, the table avoids presenting a false precision.

Battle of Venni	Early Chola period	Chola king Karikala and a coalition involving the Chera and Pandya rulers	Chola victory; associated with Karikala's consolidation of Chola power
Battle of Koppam	c. 1052/1054 CE	Cholas under Rajadhiraja I / Rajendra II and Western Chalukyas under Someshvara I	Chola victory; Rajadhiraja I was killed, and Rajendra II took command
Battle of Maski (Musangi)	c. 1020–1021 CE	Rajendra Chola I and Western Chalukya ruler Jayasimha II	Chola victory in the campaign; part of the wider Chola–Chalukya struggle
Kalinga War	c. 261 BCE	Mauryan Empire under Ashoka and Kalinga	Mauryan victory; profound impact on Ashoka's later policy and association with Dhamma

Note: The supplied reference incorrectly attributed the Kalinga War to “Raja Anant Padmanabhan.” That entry has been corrected to Kalinga as the opposing polity.

2. Tarain and Major Rajput-Period Battles

1st Battle of Tarain	1191	Prithviraj Chauhan and Muhammad of Ghor	Prithviraj Chauhan defeated Muhammad of Ghor
2nd Battle of Tarain	1192	Prithviraj Chauhan and Muhammad of Ghor	Muhammad of Ghor won; major turning point in north Indian political history
3rd Battle of Tarain	1215	Ilutmish and Yalduz	Ilutmish defeated Yalduz

Rajput and early Mughal-period battles

Khanwa	1527	Babur and Rana Sanga	Babur's victory; strengthened Mughal position in North India
Ghaghara	1529	Babur and the eastern Afghan forces associated with Mahmud Lodi	Babur's victory; consolidated his position after Panipat and Khanwa
Haldighati	1576	Maharana Pratap's forces and Mughal forces commanded by Raja Man Singh	Tactical outcome is debated; Mughal forces held the field, but Pratap continued resistance

3. Battles of Panipat

The three battles of Panipat were fought in 1526, 1556 and 1761. The supplied PDF contained an incorrect date for the first battle and an incorrect remark for the third; these have been corrected.

1st Battle of Panipat	21 April 1526	Babur and Ibrahim Lodi	Babur	Marked the beginning of Mughal rule in North India; early major use of gunpowder firearms and field artillery in the conflict
2nd Battle of Panipat	5 November 1556	Akbar's Mughal forces and Hemu	Mughal forces	Secured Akbar's position in North India
3rd Battle of Panipat	14 January 1761	Maratha army and Ahmad Shah Durrani's coalition	Durrani coalition	Major Maratha defeat; temporarily checked Maratha expansion in North India

Important correction: "Treaty of Surat" is not the outcome of the Third Battle of Panipat. The battle ended in a Durrani-coalition victory; the Treaty of Salbai (1782) belongs to the First Anglo-Maratha War.

4. Battles of the Eighteenth Century

Battle of Plassey	23 June 1757	Siraj-ud-daulah and the East India Company under Robert Clive	East India Company victory; Mir Jafar became Nawab
Battle of Buxar	22 October 1764	East India Company vs forces of Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-daula and Shah Alam II	East India Company victory; followed by the Treaty of Allahabad (1765)
Battle of Wandiwash	22 January 1760	British East India Company and French forces	British victory; decisive in the struggle for French and British influence in South India
Battle of Chausa	26 June 1539	Humayun and Sher Shah Suri	Sher Shah Suri victory
Battle of Goa	1638-1639	Portuguese and Dutch forces	Portuguese victory

Plassey and Buxar are especially important for understanding the East India Company's transition from a trading power to a major political power in Bengal and North India.

5. Carnatic Wars and Anglo-Mysore Wars

Carnatic Wars

1st Carnatic War	1746–1748	English and French	Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle (1748)
2nd Carnatic War	1749–1754	English and French, amid succession disputes in the Carnatic and Hyderabad	Treaty of Pondicherry (1754)
3rd Carnatic War	1756–1763	English and French	Treaty of Paris (1763); British position strengthened

Anglo-Mysore Wars

1st Anglo-Mysore War	1767–1769	Mysore under Hyder Ali and the East India Company with changing alliances	Treaty of Madras (1769)
2nd Anglo-Mysore War	1780–1784	Mysore under Hyder Ali / Tipu Sultan and the East India Company	Treaty of Mangalore (1784)
3rd Anglo-Mysore War	1790–1792	Mysore under Tipu Sultan and the British-led coalition	Treaty of Seringapatam (1792)
4th Anglo-Mysore War	1799	Mysore under Tipu Sultan and the British-led forces	Tipu Sultan killed; Mysore defeated

6. Anglo-Maratha Wars

1st Anglo-Maratha War	1775-1782	East India Company and Maratha Confederacy	Treaty of Salbai (1782); peace between the two sides
2nd Anglo-Maratha War	1803-1805	East India Company and major Maratha powers	British gained major territorial and political advantages; Treaties included Deogaon and Surji-Anjangaon
3rd Anglo-Maratha War	1817-1818	East India Company and Maratha Confederacy	British victory; Peshwa's authority ended and Maratha Confederacy ceased to be a major political power

Important correction: The Treaty of Bassein (1802) was a major prelude to the Second Anglo-Maratha War, not its final settlement.

7. Anglo-Sikh and Anglo-Afghan Wars

Anglo-Sikh Wars

1st Anglo-Sikh War	1845–1846	Sikh Empire and British East India Company	British victory; Treaty of Lahore (1846)
2nd Anglo-Sikh War	1848–1849	Sikh forces and British East India Company	British victory; Punjab annexed in 1849

Anglo-Afghan Wars

1st Anglo-Afghan War	1839–1842	British Indian forces and Afghan forces	British withdrawal after severe losses; Dost Mohammad returned to power
2nd Anglo-Afghan War	1878–1880	British Indian forces and Afghan forces	British strategic influence over Afghanistan's foreign affairs increased
3rd Anglo-Afghan War	1919	British India and Afghanistan	Treaty of Rawalpindi; Afghanistan gained control over its foreign affairs

8. Important Battles and Their Significance

Hydaspes	326 BCE	Alexander and Porus	Macedonian victory; Porus was allowed to continue ruling his territory under Alexander's wider political arrangement
Kalinga War	c. 261 BCE	Ashoka's Mauryan Empire and Kalinga	Associated with Ashoka's later embrace and propagation of Dhamma
Chandwar	1194	Muhammad of Ghor and Jayachandra of Kannauj	Ghurid victory; important in the expansion of Ghurid power in North India
Chanderi	1528	Babur and Medini Rai's forces	Mughal victory; Chanderi came under Mughal control
Chausa	1539	Sher Shah Suri and Humayun	Sher Shah Suri victory; Humayun was defeated
Kanauj (Kannauj/Bilgram)	1540	Sher Shah Suri and Humayun	Sher Shah Suri victory; Humayun lost control of North India
Talikota	1565	Vijayanagara Empire and a coalition of Deccan Sultanates	Vijayanagara suffered a decisive defeat and Hampi was sacked; the empire continued for decades afterward
Samugarh	1658	Aurangzeb and Dara Shikoh	Aurangzeb's victory in the Mughal war of succession

9. World Wars

First World War	1914-1918	Central Powers vs Allied Powers	Allied victory; Treaty of Versailles signed in 1919 as the principal peace treaty with Germany
Second World War	1939-1945	Axis Powers vs Allies	Allied victory; Germany and Japan surrendered in 1945

Exam note: The Treaty of Versailles was signed on 28 June 1919. It was one of the major peace settlements following the First World War.

10. Post-Independence Wars

India-Pakistan

First Kashmir War	1947-1948	Ceasefire; conflict ended with a UN-backed ceasefire arrangement, leaving the territory divided
India-Pakistan War	1965	Ended through the Tashkent Declaration (1966)
India-Pakistan War	1971	India supported Bangladesh's liberation struggle; Pakistan's eastern command surrendered and Bangladesh emerged as an independent state
Kargil War	1999	Indian forces evicted Pakistani intruders from occupied positions; Operation Vijay concluded successfully

Kargil correction: "India regained possession of Kargil" is too imprecise. The key point is that Indian forces evicted Pakistani intruders from positions on the Indian side of the Line of Control during Operation Vijay.

India and Other Neighbours

Sino-Indian War	1962	India and China	Chinese forces gained control of Aksai Chin; fighting occurred in both Ladakh and the then North-East Frontier Agency
First Anglo-Burmese War	1824-1826	British India and Burma	Treaty of Yandabo (1826)
Second Anglo-Burmese War	1852	British India and Burma	British annexation of Lower Burma
Third Anglo-Burmese War	1885	British India and Burma	Upper Burma annexed; Burma was incorporated into British India

11. Quick Revision Sheet

High-yield chronology

326 BCE	Battle of Hydaspes — Alexander vs Porus
c. 261 BCE	Kalinga War — Ashoka vs Kalinga
1191 / 1192	First and Second Battles of Tarain
1526	First Battle of Panipat — Babur
1527	Battle of Khanwa — Babur vs Rana Sanga
1556	Second Battle of Panipat — Akbar's forces vs Hemu
1565	Battle of Talikota — Vijayanagara defeated by Deccan Sultanates
1757	Battle of Plassey
1761	Third Battle of Panipat
1764	Battle of Buxar
1769	Treaty of Madras — First Anglo-Mysore War
1782	Treaty of Salbai — First Anglo-Maratha War
1792	Treaty of Seringapatam — Third Anglo-Mysore War
1799	Fourth Anglo-Mysore War
1817-1818	Third Anglo-Maratha War
1845-1846	First Anglo-Sikh War
1848-1849	Second Anglo-Sikh War
1914-1918	First World War
1939-1945	Second World War
1962	Sino-Indian War
1971	India-Pakistan War and Bangladesh's independence
1999	Kargil War — Operation Vijay

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This resource is an original Jumpstart Academy presentation based on the supplied reference's topic coverage, with factual corrections made where the reference contained errors. It is intended for educational use and should be cross-checked with standard textbooks for advanced study.